



Department of Languages, Literatures, and Cultures

ASL 101: Introductory American Sign Language I

Winter 2026 CASL 101 Section 4J0

Date and Time: Thursdays 6:00 pm – 9:00 pm

Classroom: Virtual

This is a Lower Level Liberal Studies elective course.¹

Lecturer Information

- **Name:** Chris Moreau
- **Office Location:** Virtual (By Appointment)
Office Hours: TBD
- **Course Website:** my.torontomu.ca (for courses using D2L)
- **Email Address:** christina.moreau@torontomu.ca

Email Policy

I will only be responding to e-mails with the course section code in the subject line on Mondays to Thursdays from 9:00 am to 4:00 pm within in 48 hours. I do not respond to your emails during the weekend. If you email me on Friday, I will respond on the following Monday.

In accordance with the Policy on TMU Student E-mail Accounts ([Policy 157](#)), TMU requires that any electronic communication by students to TMU faculty or staff be sent from their official TMU email account.

Course Description

This professional elective course is designed for hearing students wishing to acquire some of the basic vocabulary and grammatical structures of American Sign Language (ASL). Through active participation, students learn to communicate in ASL, developing their ability to understand and use ASL fingerspelling, simple affirmative and interrogative statements. Students also learn to converse in ASL. By the end of this course, students should know 500 signs. Students with restricted dexterity may find the production of signs challenging.

¹ This course is designated as a lower level liberal studies course. Liberal studies courses always have the designation (LL) or (UL) in their course description in the Ryerson Calendar. Courses not identified as either (LL) or (UL) are NOT liberal studies courses and will not be used towards the fulfillment of a liberal studies requirement for graduation purposes. Please note that certain liberal studies courses, due to their close

relation to a program's professional or core studies, cannot be taken for liberal studies credit by students in some programs. A list of these programs and the restricted courses is provided in (insert "Table A Lower Level Restrictions" or "Table B Upper Level Restrictions") in the TMU undergraduate calendar.

Teaching Methods

Live sessions on Zoom, pre-recorded lectures, practice dialogues on Zoom, uploaded videos on discussion boards, one-to-one meetings on video chat, and practice using visual supports.

Asynchronously: Students are expected to watch pre-recorded lectures on D2L, complete assignments and comprehension practice on D2L, participate in discussion boards, practice class activities/drills, complete assigned readings, participate in one-to-one meeting and small group meetings.

Review the information on your workbook/videos and complete the weekly comprehension practice quizzes on your own.

Unit 1 = 1:6, 1:7, 1:9, 1:10, 1:11 & 1:12

Unit 2 = 2:2, 2:3, 2:5, 2:7, 2:8, 2:10, 2:11 & 2:12

Unit 3 = 3:2, 3:3, 3:4, 3:6, 3:7, 3:8, 3:11, 3:12, 3:14 & 3:15

Synchronously: The length of live sessions will last approximately 60 minutes (Depending on the lessons, the class would be a bit longer). Live sessions on Zoom mainly focus on the opportunity for the students to interact with each other, practice dialogues, gain cultural awareness, and receive and provide feedback. Be prepared to watch the pre-recorded lectures and other course materials before attending the live sessions to be prepared for class.

Practice and complete the weekly comprehension practice quizzes with me in class (Zoom).

Unit 1 = 1:1, 1:2, 1:3, 1:4, 1:5, & 1:8

Unit 2 = 2:1, 2:4, 2:6, & 2:9

Unit 3 = 3:1, 3:5, 3:9, 3:10 & 3:13

All of the classes will be delivered through Zoom. It is strongly encourage that you review the relevant guides (Zoom). This course is a visual language. It is **mandatory** that students must have their camera on during classes.

Course Materials

Required Text:

Smith, C, Lentz, E., & Mikos, K. (2008). *Signing naturally: Student Workbook, Units 1-6*. San Diego, CA: Dawn Sign Press. - \$89.00 USD

Recommended Texts and Links:

Deaf Learn Now. (2020). *ASL Dictionary*. Toronto, ON. George Brown College. Retrieved from <https://www.deaflearnnow.ca/dictionary/>

Deaf Studies Digital Studies. (2018). Deaf Studies Digital Journals. Washington DC: Gallaudet University. Retrieved from <https://www.deafstudiesdigitaljournal.org/>

Unpacking Disability with Meriah Nichola. (2020). Unpacking Disability. Retrieved from <https://www.meriahnichols.com/deaf-posts/>

We will be using Brightspace (D2L) throughout the semester. All information will be posted on D2L. If you are not sure how to use D2L, please check out the [resources for using D2L Brightspace](#). Please refer to the information in D2L first before you email me.

Course Learning Outcomes

General Objective:

To introduce students to the fundamentals of ASL in order to enable them to communicate effectively in everyday situations, using basic signs and fingerspelling.

Learning Objective:

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Use signs to express basic concepts and numbers in ASL.
2. Use ASL in conversations that are appropriately constructed from phonological, morphological, syntax, semantic and pragmatic perspectives.
3. Respond to basic questions about themselves, using appropriate strategies.
4. Use appropriate signs related to kinship and work.
5. Understand and use familiar expressions and basic phrases to satisfy fundamental needs.
6. Introduce themselves and others using appropriate classifiers, and ask questions about personal information.
7. Explain everyday activities, events, and routines in ASL dialogues and narratives at morphological, semantic and syntax levels.
8. Interact in a simple way with others, using ASL, provided that others sign slowly and clearly and are prepared to help.
9. Narrate a story using basic ASL narrative structures.

Late Assignment Penalty

Work is due on the assigned date and at the assigned time. 5% per day will be deducted from all late work up to and including the date the work is submitted. Work that is seven days late will be deemed unacceptable and will receive a grade of 0% unless any required documentation (see 'Important Resources at Toronto Metropolitan University' below) is provided and submitted to students' home department and/or program for verification. Once verified by the student's home department, the instructor will then decide whether an extension can be granted on or based on the documentation received and communicate this decision to the student in a timely manner.

Students are required to inform their instructors of any situation which arises during the semester which may have an adverse effect upon their academic performance and must request any considerations and accommodations according to the relevant policies (see below) and well in advance. Failure to do so will jeopardize any academic appeals. If you should encounter a situation that compromises your ability to perform to your potential in this course, please notify myself and your home department and/or program as soon as possible.

Plagiarism Detection

An indication of any requirement for the submission of work to an electronic plagiarism detection service or the use of a virtual proctoring system. There is a statement which must be included if Turnitin is used (see below).

The computer should have the latest operating system, at a minimum Windows (10, 8, 7) or Mac (OS X 10.10 or higher) and web browser Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox.

Please note that you will be required to show your TMU OneCard prior to beginning to write the exam. Should a student not have a OneCard, government issued ID can be displayed to the camera, showing only the picture and name (all other information can be covered by the student).

Considerations and accommodations according to the relevant policies (see below) and well in advance. Failure to do so will jeopardize any academic appeals. If you should encounter a situation that compromises your ability to perform to your potential in this course, please notify myself and your home department and/or program as soon as possible

Class Schedule

(Please note: this schedule may change as resources and circumstances require).

Note: If you are unable to get the workbook before the first day of Winter semester, your weekly homework (Unit 1 ONLY) is due on Friday, February 6th, 2026 by 11:59 pm.

Week	Topic	Reference and Assignments
Week 1 Thurs, Jan. 15th, 2026	Course Introduction PRE-UNIT DEAF CULTURE QUIZ Unit One: 1:1-1:4 - Before class: Read student workbook - Attend class - After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	Student Workbook Unit 1:1-1:4 Due Date: Friday, January 23rd, 2026 by 11:59 pm
Week 2 Thurs, Jan. 22nd, 2026	1:5-1:8 - Before class: Read student workbook - Attend class - After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP Reflection Paper Instructions Handout	Unit 1:5-1:8 Due Date: Friday, January 30th, 2026 by 11:59 pm
Week 3 Thurs, Jan. 29th, 2026	1:9-1:12 and Unit 1 Review - Putting It All Together - Before class: Read student workbook - Attend class - After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	Unit 1:9-ALL Due Date: Friday, February 6th, 2026 by 11:59

		pm and Reflection paper
Week 4 Thurs, Feb. 5th, 2026	Unit 1 Comprehension/Knowledge Quizzes (in D2L) and Solo Dialogue Quizzes (on Zoom)	
Week 5 Thurs, Feb. 12th, 2026	<u>Unit Two: 2:1-2:6</u> • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class • After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP “Autobiography” Instructions Handout	Unit 2:1-2:5 Due Date: Friday, February 27th, 2026 by 11:59 pm (After Study Week)
February 16th – 20th, 2026	Study Week 2:7-2:9 • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	
Week 6 Thurs, Feb. 26th, 2026	2:7-2:9 • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	Unit 2.7- 2:9 Due Date: Friday, March 6th, 2026 by 11:59 pm
Week 7 Thurs, Mar. 5th, 2026	2:10-2:12 and Unit 2 Review-Putting It All Together • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class • After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	Unit 2:10-Unit 2 Review Due Date: Friday, March 13th, 2026 by 11:59 pm
Week 8 Thurs, Mar. 12th, 2026	Unit 2 Comprehension/Knowledge Quizzes (in D2L/on Zoom) and “Autobiography” (on Zoom)	
Week 9 Thurs, Mar. 19th, 2026	<u>Unit Three: 3:1-3:4 and 3:5</u> • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class • After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	3:1-3:5 Due Date: Friday, March 27th, 2026
Week 10 Thurs, Mar. 26th, 2026	3:6-3:13 • Before class: Read student workbook • Attend class	3:9-3:13 Due Date: Friday, April

	After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP	3rd, 2026 by 11:59 pm
Week 11 Thurs, April. 2nd, 2026	3:14-3:16 and Unit 3 Review - Putting It All Together - Before class: Read student workbook - Attend class - After class: Review slides, workbook, videos on DSP Unit 3 Comprehension/Knowledge Quizzes	3:14-3:16 Due Date: Friday, April 10th, 2026 by 11:59 pm (After April 10th, there will not be any requests for an extension for any of the homework or other assignments.)
Week 12 Thurs, Apr. 9th, 2026	Review - Dialogue Units 1-3	
Week 13	Final Exam – Solo dialogue (Zoom) *Please watch for more information related to the final dialogue exam on the announcement (D2L) and email.*	

Note: The final examination at the Toronto Metropolitan University will be on Sunday, April 12th – Saturday, April 25th, 2026.

Evaluation

Sign Language is a visual language, so you are asked to follow the **no-voice rule** and show culturally sensitive conduct.

Weekly Comprehension Practice Quizzes and Reflection Paper: 10%

Weekly Comprehension practice quizzes are designed to retain and reinforce what is learned in the classroom and from their student workbook. Students are asked to answer comprehension questions based on video from their Student Workbook on D2L **in classroom (Zoom) and on their own** every week. Students are also asked to type a short reflection paper based on what they have observed about ASL and Deaf culture in class and off site and apply it to content learned in the course.

Unit 1-3 Comprehension & Knowledge Quizzes: 45%

Students are asked to write down the meaning of the ASL signs presented by the lecturer. The first quiz includes words, numbers, and short statements. The speed and length of statements increases slightly in the second quiz, and again in the third quiz. Students must complete multiple choices and true/false questions related to the information they learned in class and from their workbook from units 1-3 and 6:1-8. (Comprehension Quizzes: We will call it “Weekly Homework” to avoid confusion with other assignments.)

Unit 1 Solo Dialogue Quiz (on Zoom): 10%

The test will cover material presented up to this point in the course. They will include information from the lectures, vocabulary, student workbook, and videos. Students must complete ASL dialogues related to content from unit 1.

Unit 2: Autobiography (on Zoom): 15%

Students are assigned a story that they must use their own words explaining their “Autobiography.” Students must present their autobiography to the instructor on Zoom using proper narrative structures they learned in class.

Final Exam Solo Dialogue (on Zoom): 20%

Students must complete ASL dialogues with the lecturer on Zoom related to content from units 1-3.

Assessment Weighting Breakdown

GRADING SCHEME	Percentage of Final Grade
Weekly Comprehension Practice and Reflection Paper (D2L)	10% (5% Weekly Comprehension & 5% Reflection Paper)
Unit Comprehension (Zoom) /Knowledge Quiz (Units 1-3) (D2L)	45% (3 x 15%)
Unit 1 Solo Dialogue Quiz (Zoom)	10% (1 x 10%)
Unit 2: Autobiography (Zoom)	15%
Final Exam: Solo Dialogue (Zoom)	20%
Total:	100%

University Policies

Students must be reminded that they are required to adhere to all relevant university policies found in their online course shell in D2L and/or on [the Senate website](#).

Important Resources Available at Toronto Metropolitan University

- [The University Libraries](#) provide research [workshops](#) and individual consultation appointments. There is a drop-in Research Help desk on the second floor of the library, and students can use the [Library's virtual research help service](#) to speak with a librarian, or [book an appointment](#) to meet in person or online.
- [Student Life and Learning Support](#) offers group-based and individual help with writing, math, study skills, and transition support, as well as [resources and checklists to support students as online learners](#).

- You can submit an [Academic Consideration Request](#) when an extenuating circumstance has occurred that has significantly impacted your ability to fulfill an academic requirement. You may always visit the [Senate website](#) and select the blue radio button on the top right hand side entitled: Academic Consideration Request (ACR) to submit this request.

For Extenuating Circumstances, [Policy 167: Academic Consideration](#) allows for a once per semester ACR request without supporting documentation if the absence is less than 3 days in duration and is not for a final exam/final assessment. Absences more than 3 days in duration and those that involve a final exam/final assessment, always require documentation. Students must notify their instructor once a request for academic consideration is submitted. See Senate [Policy 167: Academic Consideration](#).

- If taking a remote course, familiarize yourself with the tools you will need to use for remote learning. The [Remote Learning Guide](#) for students includes guides to completing quizzes or exams in D2L Brightspace, with or without [Respondus LockDown Browser and Monitor](#), [using D2L Brightspace](#), joining online meetings or lectures, and collaborating with the Google Suite.
- Information on Copyright for [Faculty](#) and [students](#).
- Information on Academic Integrity for [Faculty](#) and [students](#).

Accessibility

Toronto Metropolitan University is committed to making all courses accessible to students with disabilities. If any students discover an accessibility barrier with any of these course materials or technologies, please contact me via email.

Academic Accommodation Support

Academic Accommodation Support (AAS) is the university's disability services office. AAS works directly with incoming and returning students looking for help with their academic accommodations. AAS works with any student who requires academic accommodation regardless of program or course load.

- Learn more about [Academic Accommodation Support](#).
- Learn [how to register with AAS](#).
- Learn about [Policy 159: Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#)

Academic Accommodations (for students with disabilities) and Academic Consideration (for students faced with extenuating circumstances that can include short-term health issues) are governed by two different university policies. Learn more about [Academic Accommodations versus Academic Consideration](#) and how to access each.

Wellbeing Support

At Toronto Metropolitan University, we recognize that things can come up throughout the term that may interfere with a student's ability to succeed in their coursework. These circumstances are outside of one's control and can have a serious impact on physical and mental well-being. Seeking help can be a challenge, especially in those times of crisis.

If you are experiencing a mental health crisis, please call 911 and go to the nearest hospital emergency room. You can also access these outside resources at anytime:

- **Distress Line:** 24/7 line for if you are in crisis, feeling suicidal or in need of emotional support (phone: 416-408-4357)
- **Good2Talk:** 24/7-hour line for postsecondary students (phone: 1-866-925-5454)
- **Keep.meSAFE:** 24/7 access to confidential support through counsellors via [My SSP app](#) or 1-844-451-9700

If non-crisis support is needed, you can access these campus resources:

- **Centre for Student Development and Counselling:** 416-979-5195 or email csdc@torontomu.ca
- **Consent Comes First – Office of Sexual Violence Support and Education:** 416-919-5000 ext 3596 or email osvse@torontomu.ca
- **Medical Centre:** call (416) 979-5070 to book an appointment

We encourage all Toronto Metropolitan University community members to access available resources to ensure support is reachable. You can find more resources available through the [Toronto Metropolitan University Mental Health and Wellbeing](#) website.